CHART YOUR COURSE

What Do I Do With All This Stuff?

A practical guide to sorting, sharing, selling, donating and letting go, without getting overwhelmed.

You don't have to figure it all out today.
You just need a place to start.

DOWNSIZE BALTIMORE

MARY LYNCH | DOWNSIZE BALTIMORE

Start Small. Really Small.

Whether you are planning a move, simplifying your home or just tired of opening that closet and quickly closing it again, dealing with years of belongings can feel overwhelming.

So don't start with the whole house. Start with one drawer. One cabinet. One shelf. One category.

Old photographs, family letters, heirlooms and sentimental pieces can stop you in your tracks. Give yourself permission to save those decisions for later.

The Six Buckets

Bucket	What It Means
Keep	I use it, love it and know exactly where it belongs.
Family & Friends	I would rather see someone I care about enjoy it.
Sell	It may have enough value to make selling it worth the time and effort.
Donate	It is useful, but I no longer need it.
Recycle	It should stay out of the landfill if possible.
Dispose	It has reached the end of its useful life or requires special disposal.

Before You Keep Something, Ask

Do I use it? Do I love it? Would I choose it again today? Do I have a place for it?

The goal isn't to get rid of everything.
The goal is to make room for what matters.

But What Do I Actually Do With It?

Some things are easy. Some things, not so much.

- **Furniture:** Before assuming furniture is valuable, find out what similar pieces are actually selling for today. If selling it will require weeks of messages, appointments and no-shows for a relatively small return, donating may be the better win.
- **China, crystal and collectibles:** Sentimental value and resale value are two very different things. Before spending time trying to sell an entire collection, check current demand. And before assuming your children want it, ask them.
- **Clothing and household goods:** Good-condition clothing, linens, kitchenware and household items are often excellent candidates for donation. Don't let finding the perfect recipient keep bags sitting in your hallway for another six months.
- **Books:** Keep the ones you love. Offer meaningful ones to family. Donate what can be reused and recycle what cannot.
- **Photographs and family memories:** Save these for later. Photos, letters and memorabilia require more emotional energy than ordinary household items.
- **Important papers:** Don't blindly toss old paperwork. Separate documents that may need to be retained from papers that can be securely shredded.

Should I Sell It?

Before listing something, ask what it is realistically worth, how much time selling will take, and whether the likely return is worth the effort.

Sometimes getting it out of the house and into someone else's hands is the more valuable outcome.

One Bite at a Time

You don't need a dumpster this weekend.

A lifetime of belongings wasn't collected in a weekend. You don't need to sort through them in one either.

Your First Small Plan

One area I can tackle first:

Three easy things I already know can go:

1.
2.
3.

One thing I need help figuring out:

One person or resource I can call:

Then stop. Finishing one drawer is better than emptying an entire room onto the floor, becoming overwhelmed and walking away.

You don't have to be ready to move to start making life a little lighter.

Need Help With the Bigger Picture?

Sometimes the hardest part isn't deciding what goes. It's knowing who can help, where things can go, and what should happen first.

A conversation can simply be the beginning.

No pressure to sell. No giant to-do list.
Just help figuring out the next right step.

DOWNSIZE
BALTIMORE

Mary Lynch, a Certified Senior Advisor® with nearly 30 years in Baltimore real estate | Downsize Baltimore

(410) 375-1400
mary@downsizebaltimore.com | DownsizeBaltimore.com

Cummings & Co. Realtors
108 W. Timonium Road, Timonium, MD 21093 | Office (410) 823-0033